



User Object Cheat Sheet

No matter what system you're working in, it is always critical to be able to identify information about the user who is accessing that system. Being able to identify who the user is, what their groups and/or roles are, and what other attributes their user record has are all important pieces of information that allow you to provide that user with a good experience (without giving them information they don't need to have or shouldn't have). ServiceNow gives administrators some pretty simple ways to identify this information in the form of a couple of user objects and corresponding methods. This article describes the functions and methods you can use to get information about the users accessing your system.

GlideSystem User Object

The GlideSystem (gs) user object is designed to be used in any server-side JavaScript (Business rules, UI Actions, System security, etc.). The following table shows how to use this object and its corresponding functions and methods.

Function/Method	Return Value	Usage
gs.getUser()	Returns a reference to the user object for the currently	var userObject = gs.getUs

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	logged-in user.		> Authors
			> Business rules
gs.getUserById()	Returns a reference to the user object for the user ID (or sys_id) provided.	var userObject = gs.getUser().getUserById()	> Client scripts
			> CMDB
			> Content management
gs.getUserName()	Returns the User ID (user_name) for the currently logged-in user. e.g. 'employee'	var user_name = gs.getUser().getUserName()	> Design
			> Email Notifications
			> General knowledge
			> Generative AI
gs.getUserDisplayName()	Returns the display value for the currently logged-in user. e.g. 'Joe Employee'	var userDisplay = gs.getUser().getUserDisplayName()	> Graphical workflow
			> Hardware Asset Management
			> Imports
			> Integration
gs.getUserID()	Returns the sys_id string value for the currently logged-in user.	var userID = gs.getUser().getSysID()	> ITAM
			> Knowledge Management
			> Miscellaneous
			> Performance
getFirstName()	Returns the first name of the currently logged-in user.	var firstName = gs.getUser().getFirstName()	> Relationships
			> Releases
			> Reporting
getLastName()	Returns the last name of the currently	var lastName = gs.getUser().getLastName()	> Script includes



	logged-in user.		> Service Portal
			> Single Sign-on
getEmail()	Returns the email address of the currently logged-in user.	var email = gs.getUser().g	> System Definition
			> System UI
			> UI actions
getDepartmentID()	Returns the department sys_id of the currently logged-in user.	var deptID = gs.getUser().getDepartme	> UI macros
			> UI pages
			> UI scripts
getCompanyID()	Returns the company sys_id of the currently logged-in user.	var companyID = gs.getUser().getCompanyI	> Web Services
			Tags
			ACLs
			AJAX
getCompanyRecord()	Returns the company GlideRecord of the currently logged-in user.	var company = gs.getUser().getCompany	Approvals
			Attachments
			Business rules
			Catalog client scripts
getLanguage()	Returns the language of the currently logged-in user.	var language = gs.getUser().getLanguage	Change management
			Cheat Sheet
			Client scripts
getLocation()	Returns the location of the currently logged-in user.	var location = gs.getUser().getLocationC	CMDB
			Dates
			Dictionary
			Email notifications
getDomainID()	Returns the domain sys_id of the	var domainID = gs.getUser().getDomainID	Export
			GlideDialogWindow



	currently logged-in user (only used for instances using domain separation).		workflow
			highlights
			Homepages
			Incident management
			Integration
getDomainDisplayValue()	Returns the domain display value of the currently logged-in user (only used for instances using domain separation).	var domainName = gs.getUser().getDomainD	Knowledge Base
			List collector
			Module
			Popup
			Reference field
			Related lists
			Reporting
			Script includes
			Scripting
getManagerID()	Returns the manager sys_id of the currently logged-in user.	var managerID = gs.getUser().getManagerID	Security
			Service catalog
			Service Portal
			Slushbucket
getMyGroups()	Returns a list of all groups that the currently logged-in user is a member of.	var groups = gs.getUser().getMyGroups	System Security
			Trending
			UI actions
			UI macros
			UI pages
isMemberOf()	Returns true if the user is a member of the given group, false otherwise.	Takes either a group sys_	UI policy
		name as an argument.	UI scripts
			Update Sets
			Variables
gs.hasRole()	Returns true if the user has the	if(gs.hasRole('itil')){ //Do s	Views
			Widgets



given role,
false
otherwise.

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`gs.hasRole()`

Returns true if the user has one of the given roles, false otherwise.

```
if(gs.hasRole('itil,admin')){
//If user has 'itil' OR 'admin'
Do something...
}
```

`hasRoles()`

Returns true if the user has any roles at all, false if the user has no role (i.e. an ess user).

```
if(!gs.getUser().hasRoles()){
//User is an ess user...
}
```

It is also very simple to get user information even if the attribute you want to retrieve is not listed above by using a `'gs.getUser().getRecord()'` call as shown here...

```
1. //This script gets the user's title
2. gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('title');
```

g_user User Object

The `g_user` object can be used only in UI policies and Client scripts. Contrary to its naming, it is not truly a user object. `g_user` is actually just a handful of cached user properties that are accessible to client-side JavaScript. This eliminates the need for most GlideRecord queries from the client to get user information (which can incur a fairly significant performance hit if not used judiciously).

Property/Method	Return value
<code>g_user.userName</code>	User name of the current user e.g. employee
<code>g_user.firstName</code>	First name of the current user e.g. Joe
<code>g_user.lastName</code>	Last name of the current user e.g. Employee



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g_user.hasRole() True if the current user has the role specified, false otherwise. ALWAYS returns true if the user has the 'admin' role.

Usage:
g_user.hasRole('itil')

g_user.hasRoleExactly() True if the current user has the exact role specified, false otherwise, regardless of 'admin' role.

Usage:
g_user.hasRoleExactly('itil')

g_user.hasRoles() True if the current user has at least one role specified, false otherwise.

Usage:
g_user.hasRoles('itil', 'admin')

It is often necessary to determine if a user is a member of a given group from the client as well. Although there is no convenience method for determining this from the client, you can get the information by performing a GlideRecord query. Here's an example...

```
1. //Check to see if assigned to is a member of selected
   group
2. var grpName = 'YOURGROUPNAMEHERE';
3. var usrID = g_user.userID; //Get current user ID
4. var grp = new GlideRecord('sys_user_grmember');
5. grp.addQuery('group.name', grpName);
6. grp.addQuery('user', usrID);
7. grp.query(groupMemberCallback);
8.
9. function groupMemberCallback(grp) {
10. //If user is a member of selected group
11. if(grp.next()) {
12. //Do something
13. alert('Is a member');
14. }
15. else{
16. alert('Is not a member');
17. }
18. }
```

To get any additional information about the currently logged-in user from a client-script or UI policy, you need to use a GlideRecord query. If at all possible, you should use a server-side



script similar to the one shown below to query from the client for more information about the currently logged in user.

```
1. //This script gets the user's title
2. var gr = new GlideRecord('sys_user');
3. gr.get(g_user.userID);
4. var title = gr.title;
5. alert(title);
```

Useful Scripts

There are quite a few documented examples of some common uses of these script methods. These scripts can be found on the [ServiceNow docs site](#).



Mark Stanger

Date Posted:

Share This:

June 23, 2021



30 Comments



Joe February 26, 2010 at 4:55 am

Thanks for the great tips... My personal favorite:

```
gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('title');
```

never knew you could do that, awesome!



Alex March 23, 2011 at 12:44 am

I was looking for a way to get the default set to the User Time Zone. Looked everywhere and it was on my favorite site..!

```
javascript:gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('time__zone');
```

Thanks!

valor January 10, 2013 at 12:00 pm



The time zone selector sets the User's Session TZ, but not their default.

For more consistent results, use the following:

```
var tzStr =  
gs.getSession().getTimeZoneName(); //  
"US/Pacific"  
var jTZ = gs.getSession().getTimeZone(); //  
sun.util.calendar.ZoneInfo java object. APIDoc  
linked below
```

Java doc ZoneInfo api:

<http://www.docjar.com/docs/api/sun/util/calendar/ZoneInfo.html>



Wolfgang October 25, 2011 at 7:20 am

Thank you for the great work... finally one place to get the information about the UserObject stuff...

Just one note:

- the hasRole() returns true, if the user has the role specified (e.g. hasRole(role)) OR the admin role.
- to get a true/false for a specific role, use hasRoleExactly(role), which will only return true, if the user has the itil-role.



Mark Stanger October 25, 2011 at 8:04 am

Thanks for the feedback. This method had some issues in the past (which is why I didn't include it). It looks like it's in the official ServiceNow doc now though so hopefully I'm safe in including it here :). I just added it to the article above.



Andreas February 7, 2013 at 2:20 pm

I looked at the Usage example for "isMemberOf()" and also checked the wiki article for the function "getUserByID" (http://wiki.servicenow.com/index.php?title=Getting_a_User_Object&redirect=no#Method_Detail) but I cannot get it to work.

Is this function maybe retired?



```

2.    gs.print(JSUtil.type_of(usr)); //Result: "null"
3.    gs.print(usr.hasRoles()); //e.g. this
    GlideSystem function for the user object is not
    available. Result is "undefined"
4.
5.    var usr2 = gs.getUser();
6.    gs.print(JSUtil.type_of(usr2)); //Result:
    "object"
7.    gs.print(usr2.hasRoles()); //here the
    GlideSystem function for the user object is
    available. Result is "true"

```



Mark Stanger February 7, 2013 at 5:23 pm

I'm not having any luck with it either. I haven't heard of it being retired, but you'll probably need to contact ServiceNow support to see. Please post back here with your findings.



Andreas February 8, 2013 at 7:45 am

Here we go: first we have to initialize a variable with "getUser()". After that we can get any user object using it's sys_id or UserID.

Below the updated code to make the example work:

```

1.    //get object for specific user
2.    var usr = gs.getUser();
3.    usr =
    usr.getUserByID('beth.anglin');
    //instead of UserID it is possible
    to use the sys_id
4.
5.    var group = 'Service Desk';
6.    if (usr.isMemberOf(group)) {
7.        gs.log(usr.getName() + " is a
    member of " + group);
8.    } else {
9.        gs.log(usr.getName() + " is NOT
    a member of " + group);
10.   }

```



Mark Stanger February 8, 2013 at 8:12 am

Thanks Andreas! I've updated the table above with this solution.



Abdul Fathah April 12, 2013 at 7:21 am



Mark Stanger April 12, 2013 at 8:16 am

Yes. Check out 'isMemberOf' above.



Abdul Fathah April 12, 2013 at 8:50 am

sorry Mark. i forget to mention, is it possible to do this in client script?



Mark Stanger April 12, 2013 at 8:53 am

Not directly. You could easily do a client-side GlideRecord query against the 'sys_user_grmember' table to find that though. Just make sure to do an asynchronous gliderecord query with a callback. You can find an example of this type of script here...
<https://servicenowguru.com/scripting/client-scripts-scripting/gform-getreference-callback/>



Abdul Fathah April 12, 2013 at 9:01 am

Thanks Mark.



Martin Robinson October 8, 2013 at 6:49 am

Hi Mark,

Thanks for all the info, very handy and interesting indeed. One question though, is there a method like the var hasRoleExactly that will work server-side? I can get it to work okay client-side but that's it.

Thanks Martin



Mark Stanger October 8, 2013 at 8:22 am

I don't know of any built-in way of doing this, but you could always query the 'sys_user_has_role' table directly or create an on-demand script include that would allow you to call it in a shorthand way.



Cheers



Shane C January 29, 2014 at 11:28 am

How does one get the client's business number? The wiki shows how to get the mobile number, but not the business number.

http://wiki.servicenow.com/index.php?title=Getting_a_User_Object



Mark Stanger January 29, 2014 at 12:28 pm

Up above I explain for both back-end and client-side code how you can get any attribute even if there's not a specific function defined. You can get any attribute from the back-end like this.
`gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('title');`



Shane C January 29, 2014 at 12:32 pm

If I understand that correctly, then I could use this in a script of a workflow that works on a condition of an incident being submitted, to set the value of phone for the incident, to the user's business phone, with the following script?

```
current.u_cos_contact_no =  
gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('phone');
```



Mark Stanger January 29, 2014 at 12:34 pm

Correct. As long as 'phone' is the name of the field you want to pull the value from.



Shane C January 29, 2014 at 12:38 pm

On my incident form, "Contact Phone" variable is called `u_cos_contact_no`.



For my workflow, would I want to do a custom script, or simply put do a Set Values, and then use javascript:gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('phone') ?



Shane C January 29, 2014 at 12:44 pm

An update, I made a script step in the workflow, and the following works in my system:

```
var businessphone =  
gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('phone');  
current.u_cos_contact_no =  
businessphone;
```

Now to try it as a Set Value step in the workflow, with
javascript:gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('phone');
Not sure if it will work, but it's work a shot to eliminate extra steps in the workflow.



Shane C January 29, 2014 at 12:48 pm

Sorry to keep filling this up, but I can't figure out how to edit my previous post.

On further testing,
javascript:gs.getUser().getRecord().getValue('phone')
does work in a Set Value step of the workflow, however it pulls the phone number of the user logging in the incident, not the phone number of who the "client" has been set to for the incident. Any way to modify this?

Much thanks Mark



Vivek March 8, 2017 at 5:13 am

Hi Mark,



Thanks and Regards,
Vivek



Mark Stanger March 8, 2017 at 1:33 pm

Sure. Take a look at the 'title' example at the bottom of the article. It shows how you can use a GlideRecord query to get any additional information about the user (including company) that you want.



Joel December 27, 2017 at 3:03 pm

These articles are so helpful, thank you Mark for making this public information.



abrouf July 27, 2021 at 12:53 pm

Extremely helpful, thank you, Mark!



theresa September 14, 2022 at 4:54 pm

Thank you for the awesome tips! Your whole website is fantastic. :-)

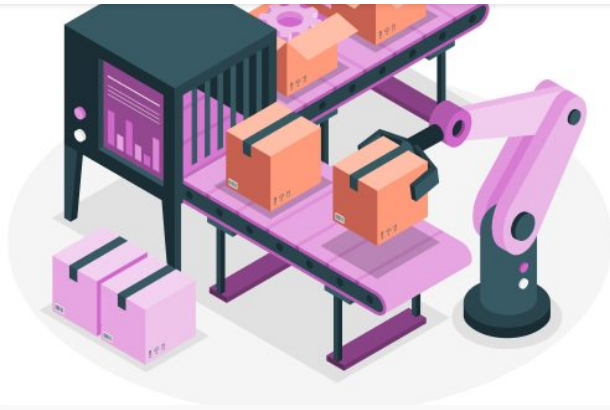


JV March 13, 2023 at 7:30 pm

Article still relevant after 13 years. Amazing !

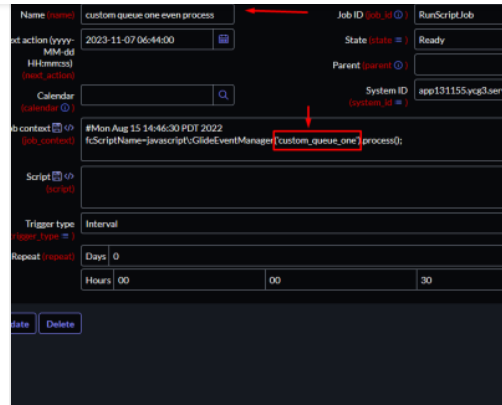
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